

Nigeria Youth Unemployment: The Headline Doesn't Tell the Whole Story.

Youth unemployment rate, 15-24 (%)

6.50

Upper secondary youth unemployment (%)

18.30

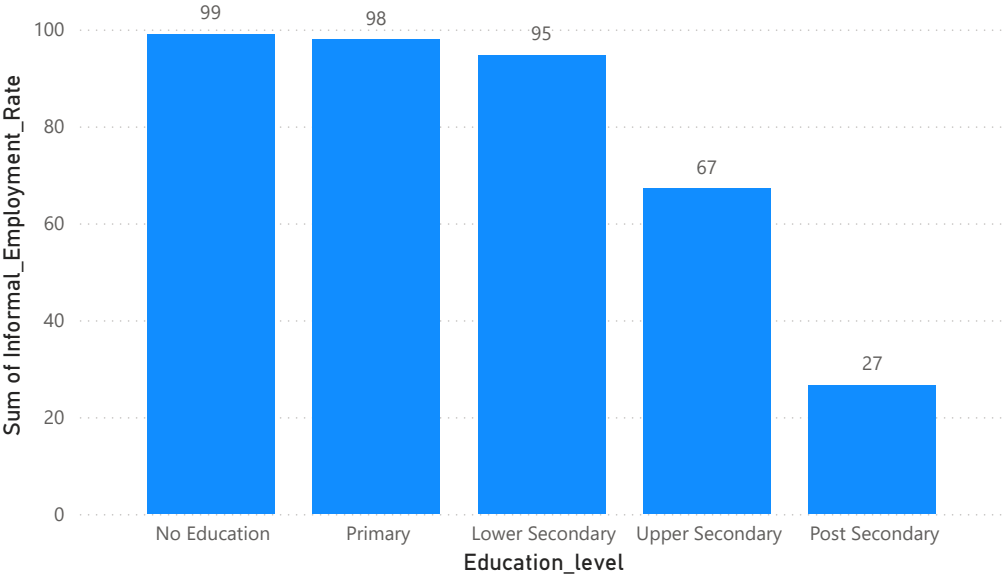
Forecast R-squared

0.036

Youth (15-24) in informal work (%)

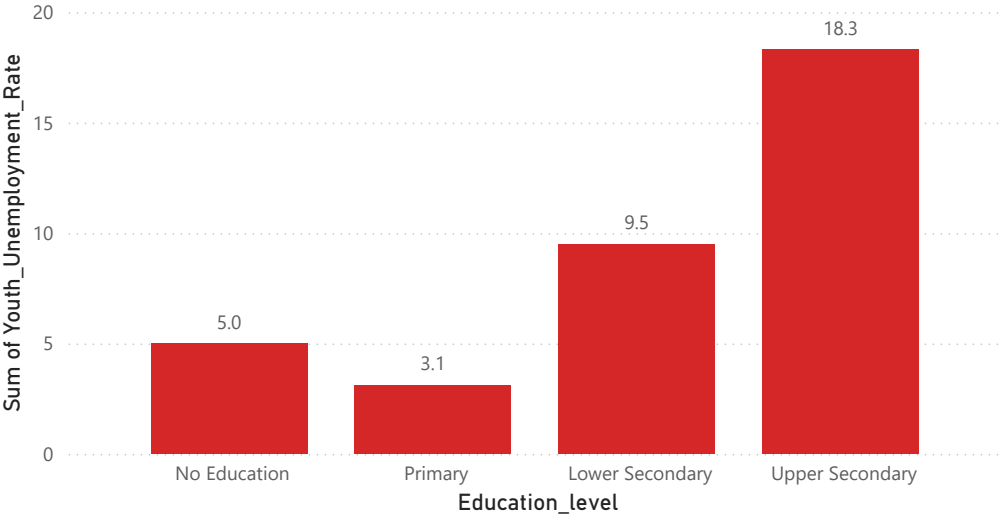
98.60

Informality falls from 99% to 27% as education rises (all workers)



Track underemployment, NEET and informality alongside the headline rate.

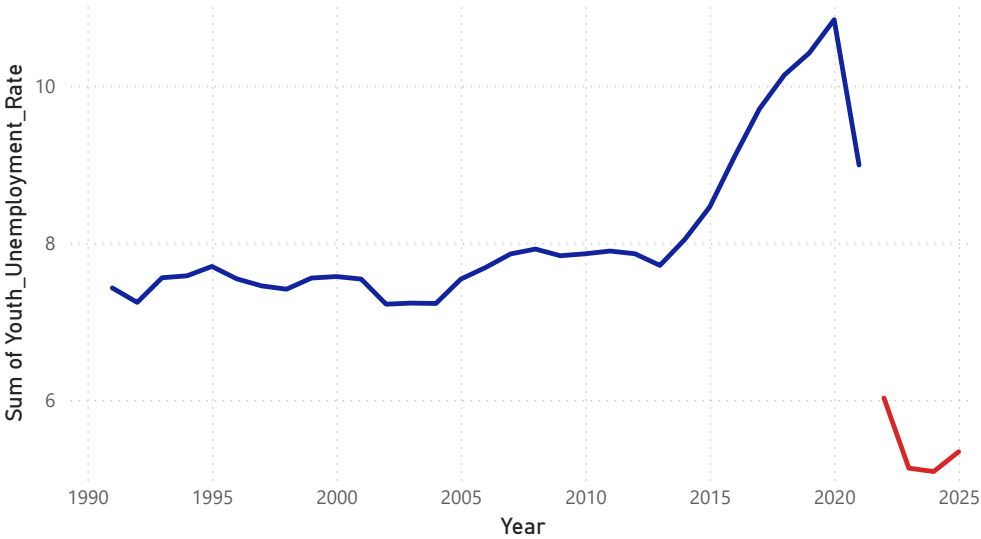
Among youth, unemployment climbs with education: 3.1% (primary) to 18.3% (upper secondary)



Recommendation: Create formal jobs for school leavers and graduates.

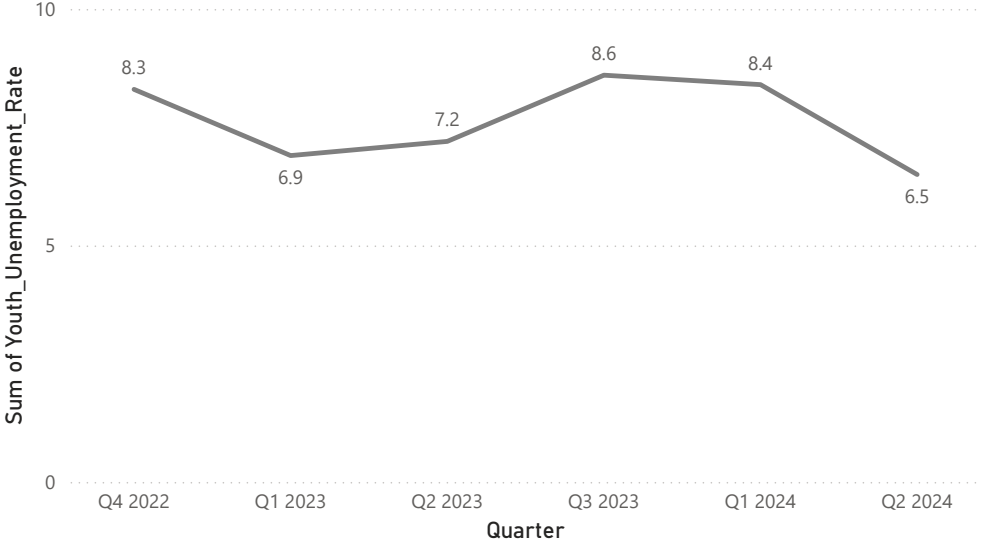
The 2022 drop is a change in how work is counted, not a recovery

Methodology ● Post-2022 (19th ICLS) ● Pre-2022



Note: Flag the 2022 methodology break in every comparison.

Six quarters, no clear trend: too early to forecast ($R^2 = 0.036$)



Recommendation: Wait for 8-12+ quarters before forecasting.